

Cosmological Arguments

13th July 2026

A question that has gripped each and every functioning human brain is the question about the existence of universe and the existence of God.

Today we find plenty of confused people, some still searching for an answer to this impossible question and others who have given up and become atheists/agnostics and a third group, which perhaps still form the majority of the world population, that turns towards organised religion to state their need for an answer. This question, as old as the human existence itself, is no small feat to answer. And I am not going to try to answer this question. I'm a Muslim and I do have my own beliefs, but today I want to discuss arguments/philosophies pertinent to this ontological question. We are going to list and try to understand the Cosmological Arguments i.e. the arguments in the favour of an external existence to the universe. They try to establish and prove that the existence of universe cannot be substantially explained by any cause within, thus there must exist 'God'.

I know three types of these cosmological arguments; Kalam cosmological argument, Aquinas cosmological argument and Leibniz contingency argument. Though there may

exist more, I shall try to focus on them and explain their understanding that I've attained in a short form.

The first and the oldest of the three is the Kalam Argument, as the name suggests it finds its origins in the muslim tradition. Ibn Sina was a proponent and in modern times William Craig have reignited it (You can even find his debates on YT).

The strength of the argument perhaps lies in its simplicity. It draws on the principle of causality i.e. everything that exists have a beginning and a cause, the universe exists, thus it must have a beginning and a cause, this cause is an existence that precedes universe and is God.

There is an inherent assumption that the principle of causality and birth holds outside of the physical universe as well. This seems to be the logical line of reasoning and Occam's Razor support it as well. I wonder how it establishes the existence of a Personal God here (I will come back to this point in the future).

The second argument is from Thomas Aquinas, at first it is easy to mistake it with the Kalam argument, but the difference is significant.

Instead of reasoning in the temporal dimension (which raises many questions about the nature of time), it tries to reason along the spatial dependability dimension. Consider this, I am holding a pen, the pen, depends on me, my arm, I depend on the ground/chair where I sit, the ground depends on earth's structure and so on. By following this reasoning, we must approach a cause that is not dependent on any other cause (assumes that an infinite regression of causes) is not possible), thus at this very moment, there must exist a "first cause" ~~and~~ that is continuously sustaining everything. It does not explicitly depend on time, but when the question of birth of universe is concerned, its response is rather similar to that of Kalam.

The third and perhaps a bit different argument comes from Leibniz. Consider any object near you, let's take this pen. It might not have existed (contingent existence), but the very fact that it does exist precludes to the fact that it was spawned into existence by a willing entity, willing and able. In the same way, the universe might not have existed, but the very fact that it exists precludes to existence of a higher being.

One aspect that you might have already pinned is that these arguments (particularly Kalam and Aquinas) have an inbuilt assumption that "infinity" cannot exist in the realm of reality. They establish that one cannot have infinite regression of cause in temporal or spatial sense, thus there must be a "first mover".

Atheists raise their concern on this assumption on the basis of 3 arguments ; ① How can we be certain that infinity doesn't exist ② If this first cause exist beyond space and time, then wouldn't its existence preclude to infinity ③ Even if there was a first cause, how does it equate to the modern, Abrahamic God. The last two concerns applies to Leibniz as well. (I shall try to come back to them in future)

To summarize, these arguments establish the "first cause" by rejecting infinity. Kalam rejects infinite time, Aquinas rejects infinite causal regression and Leibniz plays on contingency (infinite possibilities). Thus perhaps, the bigger question might be whether "Infinity" can or cannot exist. A rather complicated notion, ~~for~~ but for those who trust their senses & Occam's razor, infinity shouldn't exist and in absence of infinity, I would say these cosmological arguments are stronger and solid in the favor of existence of a higher cause.